Passwords nobody can guess

Cyber security · Level 1 · Lesson 1



In this lesson you will

- Explain how programs guess passwords.
- Make a passphrase from random words.
- Use a different password for every account.
- Keep passwords secret, even from friends.

Long, different, secret

- Programs try the common guesses first
- Length beats symbols
- Three or four random words
- One account, one password
- Never shared

The passphrase challenge

1. Warm-up (3 min): what would a program guess?
2. Pick (4 min): four random words
3. Picture (5 min): one funny drawing
4. Test (3 min): recall, then swap

Use practice words only: never write a real password on the sheet.

Think about it

1. Which of your accounts matters most, and why?
2. Why don’t symbols on their own help much?
3. Where could you keep many passwords safely?

Before you go

- One account I will fix, and how.